

BRAMBLETREK

THE PUMPKIN PARTY



IT IS TIME FOR THE PUMPKIN PARTY

In the sprawling forests of Hyhill, nestled among the whispering leaves and ancient groves, lies a tradition deeply rooted in the history and hearts of the Gnawborn. This tradition is none other than The Pumpkin Party, a festival steeped in both celebration and remembrance.

During the First Era, the Gnawborn, newly exploring the bounds of their woodland realm, found solace and sanctuary within the hollows of giant pumpkins. These natural abodes protected them from the elements and predators, serving as the first homes in their burgeoning society.

As the Gnawborn evolved from survival to a thriving community, the role of the pumpkin shifted from necessity to symbol. The Pumpkin Party began as a humble event, a way to honour the humble fruit that had once offered shelter and safety. It has since blossomed into the most vibrant festival of the year, symbolising the ingenuity and resilience of the Gnawborn.

Each year, as the first autumnal leaves carpet the forest in fiery hues, the Gnawborn gather to carve, decorate, and light up pumpkins, transforming the forest into a glowing tribute to their ancestors' first shelters.

The festival is more than just a celebration; it's a vibrant reenactment of history, a communal canvas where every Gnawborn contributes to a tapestry of lights, colours, and shared memories. It is a time for storytelling, for passing down the tales of the First Era, of challenges faced and overcome with the help of the humble pumpkin.

This year, as the fairy lights twinkle among the trees and the scent of spiced pumpkin fills the air, the spirit of the first Gnawborn who once carved homes from pumpkins lives on. The Pumpkin Party is not just a festival but a bridge connecting the past with the present, a heartfelt reminder of the roots from which the Gnawborn have grown.

As the warm embrace tightens around the forest of Hyhill, you, a resourceful Gnawborn, prepare to dive into the heart of tradition, the annual Pumpkin Party. This cherished event celebrates the deep-rooted history of your ancestors who once carved homes from pumpkins in the First Era. Today, it's a vibrant festival filled with carving, costumes, and camaraderie.

Your task begins with assisting in the festive preparations, making this year's celebration unforgettable. Embark on a journey filled with playful spirits, creative challenges, and the warm glow of community. What role will you play in bringing this historic festival to life?

YOUR ROLE AT THE PARTY

As the festive preparations for the Pumpkin Party are underway, each Gnowborn has a special role to play. Your contribution is essential to bring the spirit of the festival alive.

CARD VALUE	ROLE	DETAILS
2	Master Carver	<i>The pumpkin carving station awaits your creative touch. Carve intricate designs that tell tales of old.</i>
3	Costume Conjurer	<i>Noticing a lack of costumes, you dash to the tailor's to craft delightful disguises for everyone.</i>
4	Baker's Apprentice	<i>Inspired by family traditions, you join the bakers to whip up your favourite festive treats.</i>
5	Chief Organiser	<i>With chaos around, you step up to coordinate the tasks and ensure everything goes smoothly.</i>
6	Scarecrow Sentinel	<i>As crows menace the pumpkin patch, you fashion a scare to keep these pesky birds at bay.</i>
7	Face Painter	<i>Armed with colourful berry pastes, you decorate faces with symbols of harvest and folklore.</i>
8	Basket Weaver	<i>You weave sturdy baskets perfect for gathering treats under the moonlit sky.</i>
9	Decorator Supreme	<i>Feeling the area could use more flair, you craft additional decorations to enhance the festive vibe.</i>
10	Music Maestro	<i>The quiet whispers of more music; you organise a troupe to fill the air with harmonious melodies.</i>
JACK	Potion Mixer	<i>Amidst the bustling crowd, you concoct your famous drink that's sure to lift spirits.</i>
QUEEN	Lightbringer	<i>To comfort children afraid of the dark, you illuminate the party with enchanting fairy lights.</i>
KING	Leader of the Band	<i>Seeing the need for leadership, you guide the villagers in setting up and running the event smoothly.</i>
ACE	Magician of the Eve	<i>Believing no party is complete without a touch of magic, you dazzle the crowd with mysterious tricks.</i>

COMPANIONS AT THE PARTY

As the last touches of decoration brighten the clearing and the festive air fills with laughter, you pause to take in the beauty of it all. The evening is alight with joy and the glow of fireflies. Amidst this magical ambience, a familiar figure approaches.

CARD VALUE	ROLE	DETAILS
2	The Raven Scribe	<i>A wise raven with a basket full of mysterious runes approaches you.</i>
3	Bristleback Buddy	<i>The spiky silhouette of a bristleback emerges, eager to join in the fun.</i>
4	The Generous Cook	<i>Bearing a bowl of steaming pumpkin soup, the village cook offers you a taste.</i>
5	Firefly Flicker	<i>A luminescent firefly lands gently on your shoulder, its light mingling with the fairy lights.</i>
6	Childhood Friend	<i>Your oldest friend runs up with a wide smile, ready to reminisce and make new memories.</i>
7	The Friendly Ghost	<i>A glowing apparition floats by your side, its presence comforting and cheerful.</i>
8	The Wise Herbalist	<i>The village herbalist, curious about your latest adventures, meets you with a bundle of fresh herbs.</i>
9	Beloved Kin	<i>A family member you haven't seen in ages approaches with a warm, welcoming embrace.</i>
10	Will-o'-the-Wisp	<i>A soft, pulsing light of a will-o'-wisp floats near, its dance enchanting and inviting.</i>
JACK	Forest Fox	<i>A curious fox, larger than usual, peeks from the trees, its eyes sparkling with mischief.</i>
QUEEN	Children's Brigade	<i>A group of energetic children surround you, their eyes wide with wonder, eager for stories.</i>
KING	The Village Mayor	<i>The mayor approaches, his handshake firm and grateful, acknowledging your contributions.</i>
ACE	Mysterious Masquerader	<i>An unknown figure in a spectacular costume approaches, their identity a playful mystery.</i>

CHOOSE YOUR ADVENTURE

With the festivities in full swing and a friend by your side, it's time to dive into the heart of the Pumpkin Party. The village square is alive with laughter, music, and the sweet scent of autumn treats. What will you explore first? Draw a card to decide your next activity, you can draw up to three times to experience all the delights the evening has to offer.

CARD SUIT	EVENT	STAT CHANGE
HEARTS	Pumpkin Hunt	Venture into the pumpkin patch to seek out hidden surprises and festive treasures. Refer to the pumpkin patch hunt table for your finds.
DIAMONDS	Spirit Catching	Engage with the ethereal guests of the party. Draw to see which spirit you encounter and help guide them back to peace. Visit the spirit catching section.
CLUBS	Costume Contest	Show off your costume or admire the creativity of others. Each costume tells a story. Participate in the contest and see how you fare.
SPADES	Pie Tasting	Indulge in a delicious array of pies, each a masterpiece of flavor. Head over to the pie tasting section to sample the best the village bakers have to offer.

CARD VALUE	PUMPKIN HUNT (HEARTS)	STAT CHANGE
2	You discover a mini jack o'lantern, skillfully carved and glowing warmly.	Mini Jack o'Lantern: Perfect light for the evening. Allows you to redraw your next encounter.
3	A soft glow leads you to a beautifully crafted moon bracelet resting beneath a leaf.	Glow in the Dark Moon Bracelet: Emits a comforting glow. Restores 3 points of morale.
4	Hidden among the leaves, you find a candy shaped like a bat, its colour as deep as the night.	Bat Candy: Consumable. Allows you to glide for 1 minute.
5	The sweet aroma of apple pie guides you to a hidden treat, still warm from the oven.	Sweet Apple Pie: Consumable. Instantly restores health to the maximum.
6	A festive pumpkin party popper lies hidden under a pile of leaves, ready to surprise.	Pumpkin Party Popper: Loudly shoots confetti, attracting the nearest ally.
7	Tucked away, a spooky mask waits to transform your visage into that of a forest creature.	Spooky Mask: Allows you to escape combat once.
8	Draped over a branch, a shimmering cloak catches your eye with its enchanting glimmer.	Shimmering Cloak: Consumable. Dodges up to 5 damage in combat.
9	You hear a ghostly whistle, leading you to a carved pipe that calls to the spirits.	Ghost Pipe: Consumable. Summons a spirit to aid in combat, dealing 2 damage per turn.
10	A colourful bag of treats beckons, filled with sweets to energise your evening.	Bag of Treats: Consumable. Restores 2 points of health, 3 charges.
JACK	A pumpkin large enough to wear as a helmet invites you to try on its crown-like form.	Pumpkin Head: Boosts morale by 1 permanently.
QUEEN	You find a starlit raven feather that sparkles under the moonlight, promising good fortune.	Starlit Raven Feather: Redraw the next negative event.
KING	At the heart of the patch, you find the fabled Pumpkin Crown, marking you as this year's Pumpkin King.	Pumpkin Crown: Grants the title of Pumpkin King for the year; draw another item.
ACE	Amidst the festive decorations, a magical gourd lantern reveals itself, promising to light your path.	Magical Gourd Lantern: Illuminates hidden paths and enhances night encounters.

CARD VALUE	SPIRIT CATCHING (DIAMONDS)
2	A gentle purple orb floats toward you, its glow soft and melancholic. "I remember a field abloom with endless flowers. Can you guide me back there?"
3	Hesitant and timid, a green glow flickers near you. "The chirping of birds once filled my days. Where might I find them again?"
4	A bold, white orb shines with the confidence of a forgotten hero. "I wielded swords and won great battles, but whence came I?"
5	A vibrant red glow zips past, its energy palpable. "I long for heights where the sun warms the rocky crags. Do you know the place?"
6	A mellow yellow light drifts by, whispering of culinary delights. "I once baked the finest cakes of cherry & vanilla. But where was my kitchen?"
7	A pink streak, quick and bright, races past. "The rustle of silk, the warmth of stage lights. Where have all the costumes gone?"
8	Dragging slowly along, an aqua light murmurs with urgency. "The deep calls to me, its dark embrace familiar. How do I return below?"
9	An orange orb blinks rapidly as it crosses your path. "My life among crystals, tinctures, and herbs. Where did I leave my workshop?"
10	A dull grey orb appears suddenly, its presence heavy. "Time is short and I must not dally. Where is the nearest cave?"
JACK	Darting about with vibrant energy, a colourful light seeks answers. "I see visions of crystals, countless and bright. Where are they hidden?"
QUEEN	A majestic golden light settles softly near you. "Lead me, kindly soul, to something wondrous and grand. What is the most beautiful sight here?"
KING	With a spark of urgency, a silver orb pulses. "I am called to heal, to aid the ailing, but I know not where they rest. Where must I go?"
ACE	A mysterious blue light encircles you, its presence both ancient and serene. "I have tales of old, lost in the winds of time. Where might I find echoes of my past?"

CARD VALUE	COSTUME CONTEST (CLUBS)
2	Skeleton's Guise: You don an ensemble of eerie, bone-white attire, mimicking the rattling dance of a skeleton in the moonlight.
3	Mystic Mushroom: Cloaked in a cap and stem, your costume embodies a whimsical mushroom, dotted with faux dewdrops.
4	Bat's Winged Silhouette: With wings outstretched, you embody the silent, fleeting shadow of a bat under the night sky.
5	Lycan's Hide: Fur bristles along your costume as you take on the form of a fearsome werewolf, eyes glowing with feral intensity.
6	Vampire's Elegance: Draped in a cloak as dark as the night, your vampire costume comes complete with sharp, shining fangs.
7	Wizard's Robes: Adorned in starlit robes and a pointed hat, you channel the arcane wisdom of a seasoned wizard.
8	Pumpkin's Charm: Rounded and ribbed, your costume mirrors the cheerful visage of a carved pumpkin, lit from within.
9	Dragon's Majesty: Scales shimmer across your costume, with a tail that sweeps and a roar that echoes ancient power.
10	Warrior's Armor: Clad in battle-worn armor, you stand ready to defend the festivities as a noble warrior of old.
JACK	Jester's Folly: Colourful and whimsical, your jester's attire jingles with every mischievous step you take.
QUEEN	Ghost's Whisper: Ethereal and flowing, your ghost costume seems to drift on unseen breezes, hauntingly beautiful.
KING	Royal Regalia: Majestic and imposing, your royal garb commands respect with its rich fabrics and regal adornments.
ACE	Phoenix's Rebirth: Resplendent in fiery reds and golds, your costume symbolises the mythical phoenix, reborn from ash.

COSTUME CONTEST RESULTS

As the Gnowborn of Brambletrek showcase their creative costumes, the judges meticulously evaluate each participant. Here's how your costume fared in the overall contest:

CARD VALUE	OUTCOME
2-4	Rushed Effort: Amidst the rush to join the festivities, your costume unravels at the seams, barely holding together as you present it to the judges, earning a sympathetic score of 1/10.
5-7	Sticky Mishap: Unbeknownst to you, a sticky substance has marred your outfit. The judges notice the mishap, giving you a forgiving 3/10 for effort.
8-10	Solid Attempt: Your costume impresses the judges with its concept, but they suggest adding more details next time. Your score: a promising 5/10.
JACK	Unfinished Business: While the front of your costume dazzles, the unfinished back costs you points. Nonetheless, you score a respectable 7/10.
QUEEN	Almost Perfect: Stunning yet not quite eerie, your costume wows the crowd and secures you the runner-up position with an 8/10.
KING	Royal Success: Your costume strikes the perfect balance between impressive and intimidating, earning a near-perfect 9/10 and the victory in the contest.
ACE	Phoenix's Triumph: Your phoenix costume, resplendent and vivid, captivates everyone. It's a masterful display of craftsmanship that earns you a perfect 10/10, celebrating your rebirth as this year's costume champion.

CARD VALUE	PIE TASTING (SPADES)	STAT CHANGE
2	Apple Pie	<i>A classic delight, this pie is brimming with spiced apple slices nestled in a flaky crust.</i>
3	Cherry Pie	<i>Vibrantly red and sweet, this pie's glistening cherries offer a burst of flavor with every bite.</i>
4	Chestnut Pie	<i>Light and nutty, this pie offers a subtle, earthy flavor, perfect for a crisp autumn evening.</i>
5	Maple Pie	<i>Thick and gooey, this golden pie is a sweet homage to the maple trees surrounding the village.</i>
6	Sticky Toffee Pie	<i>Rich and decadent, the sticky toffee clings to your teeth, a reminder of childhood indulgences.</i>
7	Cheese and Onion Pie	<i>A savoury delight, this pie combines sharp cheese with sweet onions in a hearty embrace.</i>
8	Pumpkin Pie	<i>The essence of autumn packed into a pie, with a creamy filling and a hint of spice.</i>
9	Berry Pie	<i>Bursting with wild berries from the local woods, this pie is a colourful treat for the senses.</i>
10	Pear Pie	<i>Tart and sweet, decorated whimsically with pastry mice, it's a playful twist on a traditional fruit pie.</i>
JACK	Nettle Pie	<i>Earthy and unexpected, this pie reminds you of woodland walks and the tang of fresh nettles.</i>
QUEEN	Golden Honey Syrup Pie	<i>Lusciously sweet and thick, it's a decadent treat that's almost too rich to finish.</i>
KING	Ghost Pie	<i>An enigmatic offering that seems almost ethereal, leaving a lingering taste of something unforgettable.</i>
ACE	Custard Pie	<i>Creamy and comforting, topped with dollops of cream, it's a soothing end to a festive evening.</i>

ADVENTURES IN THE PUMPKIN PATCH

As the last echoes of laughter and music fade into the night, the true adventure at the Pumpkin Patch begins. With the moon high in the sky casting silver light across the dew-laden fields, the patch transforms into a realm of shadows and whispers. The party's remnants set the stage for a night of mystery and exploration.

You and your chosen companions, buoyed by the evening's festivities, decide to venture deeper into the patch. Legends speak of a hidden grove within the patch, where the pumpkins grow as large as cottages and hold secrets from the old times. Whispers among the elders suggest that on this night, when the veil between worlds is thinnest, one might uncover truths long buried under vine and leaf, or encounter creatures of magic drawn to the pumpkin's glow.

With a mix of excitement and trepidation, you step forward, lanterns in hand, ready to uncover what lies beneath the festive facade. What secrets do the sprawling vines hide? What spirits roam the rows of pumpkins? Tonight, the adventure unfolds under the watchful eyes of the ancient forest.

This next section will work just like general daily prompts, once you feel you're ready to head back into the wider lands of Hyhill then you can do!

CARD VALUE	HEARTS	STAT CHANGE
2	The scent of cinnamon wafts from a series of intricately carved pumpkins, reviving your spirits and filling you with warmth.	Morale +1
3	You discover a cluster of golden pumpkins emitting a soft hum that restores a sense of peace and well-being.	Health +2
4	Among the vines, you find an old watering can that, when tipped, spills out water that refreshes your supplies.	Morale +3
5	A pumpkin carved with celestial patterns glows under the moonlight, its light guides you to a forgotten path.	Morale +4
6	You trip over a hidden root and find a buried chest filled with old masks, reviving forgotten traditions and joy.	Morale +5
7	Digging in the soil, your hands uncover a cache of ancient seeds, promising the potential of growth and renewal.	Health +6
8	A whispering pumpkin beckons you to listen to old tales of the forest, rejuvenating your soul and purpose.	Health +7
9	A luminous mushroom circle under a pumpkin vine reveals a secret stash of nourishing forest fruits.	Morale +8
10	The oldest pumpkin in the patch opens up to reveal a hidden compartment with a map of forgotten trails.	Health +4, Morale +5
JACK	You find a playful spirit trapped in a pumpkin; releasing it grants you a blessing of vitality and mirth.	Combat
QUEEN	A regal pumpkin adorned with silver leaves showers you with wisdom from the elders, enriching your journey.	Combat
KING	In the heart of the patch, a pumpkin engraved with victories of past festivals fills you with inspiration.	Combat
ACE	You unearth an ancient scroll wrapped in a pumpkin leaf, detailing the origins of the Pumpkin Party, imbued with magical lore.	Morale +10

CARD VALUE	DIAMONDS	STAT CHANGE
2	You stumble upon two Gnawborn sharing tales over spiced pumpkin brew, inviting you to join and share your own stories.	Morale +2
3	A group of youngsters playing hide and seek among the pumpkins beckons you to join their playful game.	Morale +1, Supplies +1
4	You find a circle of elders reminiscing about past festivals; their wisdom and laughter enrich your spirit.	Morale +3
5	A couple of artisans are sculpting a giant pumpkin, inviting you to carve your mark alongside theirs.	Supplies +2
6	A spontaneous dance erupts as musicians strike up a lively tune, pulling you into the rhythm.	Health +2
7	You join a communal pumpkin soup tasting, where each spoonful is a warm exchange of smiles and recipes.	Health +2, Morale +1
8	A competition unfolds to stack pumpkins; your participation earns you cheers and newfound friends.	Supplies +1, Morale +2
9	You're drawn into a heartfelt conversation with a visiting trader about the wonders beyond the forest.	Morale +4
10	The lighting of the lanterns ceremony begins, and you are handed a lantern to place among the trees.	Morale +3, Supplies +1
JACK	A group of Gnawborn invites you to judge their pumpkin carving contest, a role that fills you with honour and joy.	Morale +5
QUEEN	You help organise a small play about the history of the Pumpkin Party, acting alongside enthusiastic villagers.	Morale +3, Health +1
KING	You are invited to lead the final toast of the evening, a moment that solidifies your role within the community.	Morale +6
ACE	You discover a secret gathering planning next year's festival, and they eagerly include you in their visionary circle.	Morale +4, Supplies +2

CARD VALUE	SPADES	STAT CHANGE
2	A sudden gust of wind scatters your supplies, spreading them into the dark woods.	Supplies -2
3	You accidentally step on a rotten pumpkin, slipping and bruising yourself in the fall.	Health -1, Supplies -1
4	A mischievous spirit plays tricks on you, leading you astray and away from the group.	Morale -2, Supplies -1
5	You encounter a thorny bush that scratches you as you navigate through the darker parts of the patch.	Health -3
6	A wrong turn leads you into a patch of stinging nettles, causing discomfort and slight injury.	Health -2, Morale -1
7	An old, forgotten well swallows some of your belongings as you explore near it.	Supplies -4
8	Chilly winds and eerie shadows dampen your spirits and the festive atmosphere.	Morale -4
9	You find a lantern that unfortunately goes out, leaving you in the dark and slightly disoriented.	Supplies -2, Morale -2
10	An old fence collapses under your weight, resulting in minor injuries and a loss of medical supplies.	Health -5, Supplies -2
JACK	You stumble upon a hidden ditch covered by fallen leaves, losing some time and resources recovering.	Health -4, Supplies -3
QUEEN	You accidentally disturb a beehive, resulting in a frantic escape and multiple stings.	Health -4, Morale -3
KING	The sudden appearance of a wild animal scares you, causing you to drop and break essential supplies.	Health -3, Supplies -4
ACE	A deep fog sets in, leading you far from the path; it takes hours to find your way back, exhausting your resources.	Health -4, Morale -3, Supplies -4

CARD VALUE	CLUBS	STAT CHANGE
2	You accidentally offend a fellow Gnawborn with a misunderstood joke, leading to an awkward silence.	Morale -2
3	Miscommunication leads to a small argument over the last piece of pumpkin pie.	Morale -1, Supplies -1
4	You lose a game of pumpkin toss, resulting in a small wager paid out from your supplies.	Supplies -3
5	An old friend misinterprets your comments about the festival, dampening the evening's spirits.	Morale -3
6	A playful prank goes wrong, causing slight injuries and embarrassment.	Health -2, Morale -2
7	You spill a drink on a prominent village elder, causing a moment of tension.	Supplies -2, Morale -2
8	A heated debate over the best pumpkin carving techniques sours the mood around you.	Morale -4
9	You get lost while escorting a group of Gnawborn kids, causing panic and using up resources.	Supplies -2, Morale -3
10	Misplaced festival decorations are blamed on you, putting you in an uncomfortable spotlight.	Morale -5
JACK	A competitive spirit gets the better of you during a relay race, leading to strained relations.	Morale -3, Health -2
QUEEN	A well-intentioned surprise for a friend backfires, leading to misunderstandings.	Morale -4, Supplies -1
KING	You take the blame for a mishap you didn't cause, to keep the peace, exhausting your patience and supplies.	Morale -3, Supplies -3
ACE	A major misstep in a public performance leaves you feeling embarrassed and drained.	Morale -5, Supplies -3

EPILOGUE

As the first light of dawn streaks across the sky, casting a gentle glow over the pumpkin patch, the echoes of laughter and the soft hum of celebration begin to fade. The night's enchantment slowly gives way to the quiet calm of morning, and you find yourself wandering through the now silent patch, reflecting on the night's adventures.

Each carved pumpkin, each strewn decoration, tells a story of the festivities that unfolded. A night of shared tales, playful spirits, and communal joy. The challenges you faced, whether losing resources in a misadventure or navigating the complexities of social interactions, have left you with lessons about resilience and the importance of community. These lessons weave into your spirit, enriching your understanding of the Gnawborn heritage and the bonds that tie you to both the land and your fellow creatures.

As you walk, the soft rustling of the leaves underfoot and the occasional chirp of a waking bird are your companions. You pause by a particularly large pumpkin, its face still holding the flicker of a candle, now nearly burned out. It serves as a poignant reminder that all moments, however magical, are fleeting. Yet, the memories created, the friendships deepened, and the traditions celebrated will linger much longer, like the ever-present scent of cinnamon and pumpkin in the air.

You leave the patch not just with a basket of treats or a new tale to tell, but with a heart fuller and a spirit more attuned to the rhythms of Brambletrek's seasons. The Pumpkin Party may be over, but its spirit will continue to inspire and guide you as you explore the wider mysteries and delights of the forest in the days to come.

Thus, as the sun fully rises, casting its warm embrace over Hyhill, you step out of the pumpkin patch with renewed vigour and a deepened sense of belonging. The path ahead is uncertain, filled with the unknown twists and turns of life's journey, but for now, the forest seems a little friendlier, the shadows less daunting, and the story of your life richer for the night spent under the pumpkin-lit moon.